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Microsoft Word vs. Google Docs

A comprehensive, evidence-backed demonstration document

Positioning thesis

Word provides the real-time collaboration people expect from modern cloud editors while adding deeper professional document production, formal review, rich desktop features, enterprise security, automation, accessibility, and file-format control.

Prepared for	Executive / Sales / IT decision-makers
Prepared by	Microsoft Word capability team
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Status	Draft for review – use Track Changes and comments for sign-off

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Tip: In Word, right-click the Table of Contents and choose “Update Field” to refresh page numbers.

1. Executive summary

Microsoft Word should be positioned as the premium document platform: it matches the cloud collaboration benefits commonly associated with Google Docs, then extends beyond them with mature legal-grade review, long-document production, advanced layout, enterprise-grade protection, automation, accessibility, and integration across Microsoft 365.

3. Capability matrix: Word has all the expected basics plus professional depth

<u>Capability</u>	<u>Google Docs expectation</u>	<u>Microsoft Word answer</u>	<u>Word advantage</u>
<u>Real-time coauthoring</u>	<u>Multiple users edit in a browser</u>	<u>Coauthoring in Word desktop/web when stored in OneDrive/SharePoint</u>	<u>Collaboration with desktop-grade layout and review controls</u>
<u>Comments & mentions</u>	<u>Comments, suggestions, action items</u>	<u>Threaded comments, @mentions, tasks, resolved threads</u>	<u>Integrated with Outlook/Teams/Microsoft 365 identity</u>
<u>Change review</u>	<u>Suggesting mode</u>	<u>Track Changes: insertions, deletions, formatting, reviewer identity, accept/reject, lock tracking</u>	<u>More formal review workflow for legal, editorial, regulated documents</u>
<u>Version history</u>	<u>Restore prior versions</u>	<u>Version history through OneDrive/SharePoint; local file versioning options</u>	<u>Cloud + enterprise repositories + records processes</u>
<u>Long documents</u>	<u>Headings, outline, basic TOC</u>	<u>TOC, captions, cross-references, indexes, bibliography, fields, master-document practices</u>	<u>Better for reports, contracts, manuals, theses</u>
<u>Formatting/design</u>	<u>Basic styles/tables/images</u>	<u>Advanced styles, themes, columns, section breaks, page setup, watermarks, object placement</u>	<u>Higher-fidelity professional output</u>
<u>Mail merge</u>	<u>Requires add-ons/workarounds</u>	<u>Native mail merge with Excel/Outlook data</u>	<u>Production-ready personalized letters, labels, envelopes, email merges</u>
<u>Automation</u>	<u>Apps Script/add-ons</u>	<u>VBA macros, Office Scripts ecosystem, COM/add-ins, Power Automate, content controls</u>	<u>Broader enterprise automation surface</u>
<u>Security/compliance</u>	<u>Drive permissions/admin controls</u>	<u>Purview labels, encryption, DLP, retention/eDiscovery integration, IRM, protected view</u>	<u>Deeper Microsoft 365 governance stack</u>
<u>AI assistance</u>	<u>Gemini/Smart Compose depending on plan</u>	<u>Copilot in Word plus Editor, summaries, drafting, rewrite, M365 grounding where licensed</u>	<u>AI integrated with M365 data and compliance controls</u>
<u>Offline capability</u>	<u>Offline mode after setup</u>	<u>Full desktop application plus offline files synced later</u>	<u>Most capable no-internet document editor</u>